

Plants for Asian-style gardens

Reflecting Buddhist philosophies, Japanese gravel, stroll, and tea gardens are admired for their beauty and tranquility.

Japanese gravel gardens comprise large boulders and minimal planting—traditional dry gardens include only moss—with miniature pines and clipped Japanese holly used to decorate these spare schemes. The more exuberant stroll and tea gardens allow a greater planting range, including cloud-pruned topiary, colorful maples, bamboos, irises, and seasonal flowering shrubs, such as rhododendron and peony. Combine these plants to create a miniaturized woodland or water landscape and include winding paths and open spaces to achieve an authentic look.



SHRUB SMALL

Cryptomeria japonica 'Globosa Nana'

JAPANESE CEDAR This dwarf evergreen domed conifer has scaly green foliage and green turning brown cones. Use to create a rounded shape between rocks in a gravel garden, or grow in a pot as a focal plant.

↑→3ft (1m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z6–9



PERENNIAL SMALL

Hakonechloa macra 'Aureola'

JAPANESE FOREST GRASS This slow-growing grass has green-striped yellow leaves that age to reddish brown. Reddish brown flower spikes appear in early fall and last into winter.

Grow in a pot or gravel garden.
↑16in (40cm) ↔24in (60cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z5–9



SHRUB LARGE

Eriobotrya japonica

LOQUAT This architectural shrub produces large, glossy dark green leaves, felted beneath, at the end of branched stems. It makes a dramatic focal point, but needs a sheltered site to produce its scented white flowers from fall to winter.

↑→25ft (8m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z8–11



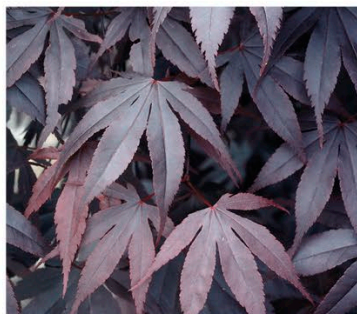
SHRUB MEDIUM

Hydrangea macrophylla

LACECAP HYDRANGEA This rounded shrub produces large, oval light green leaves and, from midsummer to early fall, lacecap flower heads formed of tiny blue flowers, and larger pale blue (in acidic soil), or pink petal-like florets.

↑6ft (2m) ↔8ft (2.5m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z6–9



TREE SMALL

Acer palmatum 'Bloodgood'

JAPANESE MAPLE A small tree with maplike reddish purple leaves that turn bright red in fall. Winged red fruits follow the small purple spring flowers. Grow it as a feature in a Japanese stroll-style garden. May be invasive in some areas.

↑→15ft (5m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z5–8



SHRUB LARGE

Fatsia japonica

JAPANESE FATSIA An evergreen shrub with hand-shaped, glossy dark green leaves. Black fruits follow the spherical white fall flowers. Makes an attractive backdrop against a wall or fence; overwinter indoors or grow as a houseplant in cool areas.

↑→12ft (4m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z8–10



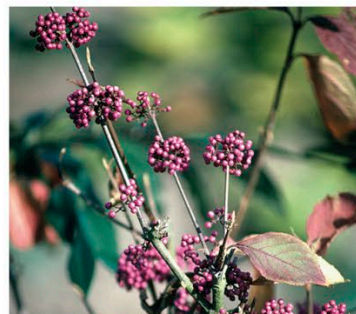
SHRUB MEDIUM

Hydrangea quercifolia

OAKLEAF HYDRANGEA This mound-forming shrub has lobed midgreen leaves that turn red and purple in fall. From midsummer to fall, cone-shaped cream flower heads appear, which age to pink-tinged white. Requires neutral to acidic soil.

↑6ft (2m) ↔8ft (2.5m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z5–9



SHRUB LARGE

Callicarpa bodinieri var. *giraldii*

BEAUTYBERRY This shrub has lance-shaped foliage and pink summer blooms. 'Profusion' (above) has purple-tinged young leaves that turn rosy pink in fall, and violet berries.

Provide a sheltered site in zone 5 gardens.
↑10ft (3m) ↔8ft (2.5m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z5–8



TREE LARGE

Ginkgo biloba

MAIDENHAIR TREE This deciduous tree has fan-shaped green leaves, butter-yellow in fall. Grow as a focal point in Japanese- and Chinese-style gardens. Dwarf cultivars are ideal for small spaces. Plant male trees to avoid the messy and smelly fruits of females.

↑100ft (30m) ↔25ft (8m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4–9



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Iris laevigata

JAPANESE WATER IRIS This clump-forming perennial marginal has sword-shaped midgreen leaves and dark purple early summer flowers with gold marks on the lower petals. Plant it in aquatic baskets at the edge of a pond or pool.

↑3ft (1m) or more ↔indefinite

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4–9